

EIC SCHOOL · ADULT B2+ · PART 2 OF 2

The Way Back

Causative verbs & passive voice

Read the text once. Then build your questions from the sentences below.

Student name

Date

THE TEXT

Read once before building your questions.

The first thing the psychologists say is the hardest to accept: you cannot make the system disappear by deciding to ignore it. Willpower, as a strategy, has been studied exhaustively, and the conclusion is consistent: it depletes. The person who makes herself resist the phone at 8am will reach for it at 8pm with twice the urgency. Resistance, without something to replace it, is just deferred consumption.

What ACT proposes instead is a shift in relationship — not with the system, but with your own responses to it. You are not asked to stop noticing the pull of the feed. You are asked to notice that you are noticing it. This small gap — between stimulus and response — is where, according to Viktor Frankl, human freedom actually lives. Letting the thought exist without acting on it is not weakness. It is the beginning of psychological flexibility.

Csikszentmihalyi arrived at a similar conclusion from a different direction. He found that the moments people reported as most meaningful were not produced by consumption but by flow states — moments of complete absorption in a task. The system, by design, makes flow nearly impossible: it interrupts before depth can develop, rewards the surface, and gets you to mistake stimulation for satisfaction.

Simone Weil called the capacity for sustained attention the highest form of human generosity. To truly attend to something — a person, a problem, a piece of music — a kind of self-emptying is required. You must let yourself be fully affected by what is in front of you. The system makes this almost impossible — every notification is a reminder that you exist, that you have preferences, that the world is waiting for your reaction.

None of this means the solution is simple, or that it can be implemented through a weekend retreat. What gets people to change sustainably is a clarification of what they actually value when the system is not making that choice for them. The question is not how do I use my phone less. The question is: what do I actually want — when nothing is making me want it?

CAUSATIVE QUESTIONS

Build the question from the sentence.

01 MAKE + BARE INFINITIVE

You cannot make the system _____ by deciding to ignore it.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

02 MAKE + BARE INFINITIVE

The person who makes herself _____ at 8am will reach for the phone at 8pm with twice the urgency.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

03 LET + BARE INFINITIVE

ACT teaches you to let the thought _____ without acting on it.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

04 MAKE + BARE INFINITIVE

The system makes flow nearly _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

05 GET + TO + INFINITIVE

The system gets you to mistake stimulation for _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

06 LET + BARE INFINITIVE

You must let yourself be fully _____ by what is in front of you.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

07 GET + TO + INFINITIVE

What gets people to change sustainably is not _____ but a clarification of values.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

PASSIVE VOICE QUESTIONS

Who is the invisible agent this time?

01 PRESENT PERFECT PASSIVE

Willpower has been studied _____ — and the conclusion is consistent: it depletes.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

02 SIMPLE PAST PASSIVE

Meaningful moments were not produced by consumption but by _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

03 PRESENT SIMPLE PASSIVE

A kind of self-emptying is required _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

04 MODAL PASSIVE

The solution cannot be implemented through _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?
